THE POWER PLAYER



Illustration by **MANJUL**

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SANJIV GOENKA, 62

CHAIRPERSON, RP-SANJIV GOENKA GROUP

BECAUSE his group has a wide range of interests, right from carbon black, power, IT, retail products, media and entertainment to sports, education and infrastructure. Consolidated revenues for the group, say reports, was more than Rs 32,000 crore for FY23

BECAUSE he's now also a sports team baron, having outbid Gautam Adani to take the Lucknow IPL franchise with a commitment of Rs 7,090 crore. He already had a football team, the ISL champions and newly rechristened Mohun Bagan Super Giants

LIGHTS ON During the 1980s, Goenka was having an adda session at Park Street with friends when the lights went off, as the unrelenting load-shedding by the city's power distribution company, CESC, kicked in. Goenka took a vow then that he'd find a solution. CESC became a group company by 1990, and Calcutta was rid of loadshedding by the noughties

BECAUSE the personable businessman has been a champion of preserving Kolkata's cultural heritage. The restoration of group headquarters, CESC House, is a case in point. The building, built in the Art Deco style in 1933, was previously known as Victoria House and houses a major selection from Goenka's art collection. The industrialist is an art aficionado and owns one of the largest collections of miniature Mughal paintings in the country